

1 YOGI ADITYANATH
Uttar Pradesh
35.3 [33.2]



ANI

1 PREM SINGH TAMANG
Sikkim
62 [55.7]

Q. Most popular CM (in home state)

Respondents in every state were asked to rate their own chief minister



2 M.K. STALIN
Tamil Nadu
57 [39.9]



3 HIMANTA BISWA SARMA
Assam
55 [50.8]



4 BHUPENDRABHAI PATEL
Gujarat
54 [46]



5 N. CHANDRABABU NAIDU
Andhra Pradesh
47 [44.4]



6 MAMATA BANERJEE
West Bengal
47 [45.5]



7 PEMA KHANDU
Arunachal Pradesh
46 [40.6]



8 MANIK SAHA
Tripura
42 [38.4]



9 VISHNU DEO SAI
Chhattisgarh
39 [36.7]



10 SIDDARAMAIAH
Karnataka
39 [24.3]

All figures in %; Feb. '25 figures in bold, Aug. '24 in []

Note: *Respondents of every state were asked to evaluate the performance of their own chief minister. For instance, 62 per cent respondents of the total of 499 from Sikkim said they were satisfied with Prem Singh Tamang while 57 per cent of the 7,456 respondents from Tamil Nadu expressed satisfaction at M.K. Stalin's performance*

Lok Sabha poll performance in the state. While 35.3 per cent of the respondents back him as the best CM, up from 33.2 per cent just six months ago, Adityanath needs to focus on building more support in his home state.

West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee ranks second nationally, maintaining her stronghold in her state through fiery rhetoric, welfare schemes and grassroots engagement. However, she trails Adityanath by a significant 25 percentage points, underscoring his dominant position. The rankings also reveal a broader trend: state leadership is almost evenly split between regional players and national parties. The top 10 list features four CMs from regional parties, four from the BJP and two from the Congress. With the BJP's partners in the mix, the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) secures six spots, solidifying its pan-India dominance.

While Adityanath leads nationally, Sikkim CM Prem Singh Tamang has solidified his dominance at home, becoming the most popular CM among his electorate for the second time. His focus on economic growth, sustainable tourism and environmental conservation has boosted his approval rating to 62 per cent. Similarly, Tamil Nadu's M.K. Stalin has seen a remarkable surge in popularity within his state, rising from 39.9 per cent in August 2024 to 57 per cent. His emphasis on Dravidian identity politics, social welfare and economic growth has, in fact, positioned him as one of the most politically stable leaders within the Opposition's Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA).

NDA ally and Andhra Pradesh CM N. Chandrababu Naidu has also reinforced his reputation as a capable administrator, ranking in the top five on both lists. Meanwhile, Assam's Himanta Biswa Sarma of the BJP has improved his home state approval rating to 55 per cent from 50.8 per cent in August 2024, driven by infrastructure development and cultural nationalism. The BJP's strong presence in the Northeast is evident with three of its CMs from the region making the top 10. Overall, the party has five CMs on this list. In contrast, the Congress struggles to make an impact, with Karnataka's Siddaramaiah being its sole representative. ■